

MYLAPORE

Mandaveli » R A Puram » Royapettah » Chindatripet » Royapuram » Korukkupet » Ennore » Luz » Alwarpet » Triplicane » Central

Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur

RERA : TN/35/Building/0399/2023
www.rera.tn.gov.in



CHENNAI'S HIGHEST ROI HOMES

📍 ECR, Muttukadu

Starts from

₹1 Cr*

Rental up to

14.40%

VRX TERRACE ADVANTAGES



70 Lifestyle
Amenities



Swim 139 ft
above sea level



Opp. to
MGM Dizzee World



Book your site visit

CREDAI

VRX | terrace



89257 72223

*T&C Apply

#LeanOnUs

GC GERI CARE
ELDERCARE BY GERIATRICIANS

Hope Lives On.

Celebrating Life Beyond Cancer.

Join us this **National Cancer Survivors Day** as we honour stories of courage, healing and resilience.

7th June 2026,
Sunday
3.30 PM Onwards



Presented by
Geri Care's



India's leading Geriatric Oncology Team for older adults dedicated to:

- ✓ Prevention
- ✓ Screening
- ✓ Rehabilitation
- ✓ Home Care and Paliative Care
- ✓ Long Term Care & Skilled Nursing Facilities
- ✓ Comprehensive Treatment Protocols

Special Guest

Viji Venkatesh

Patient Advocate & Cancer Care Leader



A renowned leader in patient advocacy, her inspiring work spans across cancer care, preventive oncology, marrow donorship, glaucoma and more. She's the founder of the "Chai for Cancer" fundraiser, and is also now an **actor in Tamil and Malayalam movies.**



The evening will conclude with an intimate **Musical Experience** dedicated to the participants.



MYLAPORE

Mandaveli » R A Puram » Royapettah » Chindatripet » Royapuram » Korukkupet » Ennore » Luz » Alwarpet » Triplicane » Central
Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur

Those accustomed to hanging out at “Namma Chennai” selfie point at Marina Beach want it back at its ‘clicking’ best once again

M SRINATH

The iconic “Namma Chennai” selfie point at Marina Beach, along the city’s recognisable photo landmarks, has remained in a damaged condition for a long period. And selfie-hungry youngsters and seniors as well do not want the delay to extend any further.

Installed to bring a sense of community and engagement to the Marina beachfront, the structure measures 28 feet in width, 10 feet in height and has a thickness of 2 feet.

Since its inauguration, it has served as a catchy backdrop for residents and tourists to freeze memories of their visit to the iconic beach.

Efforts had been initiated to restore the damaged structure before the Model Code of Conduct for the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections came into force. However, the repair works had to be put on hold



‘Get it clicking again’

when the model code kicked in.

With the election process now over and a new government in the saddle, selfie enthusiasts have urged the authorities to expedite the restoration work. To that request, Tamil language enthusiasts have appended theirs: they have urged the authorities to include the city’s name in Tamil script as well.

The selfie point in August 2024;

and (above) as it looks now.
PHOTOS: SRINATH M AND AKHILA EASWARAN



Kathak dance performance in Mylapore today

Lalitha, Tanmayaa, and Praharshidha, disciples of P. R. Venkata Subramanian, a Kathak exponent and founder of Jathiswaraalaya, will perform ‘Kathak Nrutya Aarohan’ on May 31 at 10 a.m. at Mylapore Fine Arts Club.

The performance will be graced by Nalli Kuppaswamy, actress Revathi Sankaran, and Bharatanatyam dancer Kanchana Janardhanan.

For details, contact 8925626664 or log on to Jathiswaraalaya.com.



Pencil bollards outside school in Santhome



Students returning to school after summer holidays would be surprised seeing pencil-shaped bollards, bright cautionary sign boards and redefined pedestrian pathway at school zones. As part of Greater Chennai Traffic Police’s initiative titled ‘School Safety Zone’, institutions located on busy roads are getting many such creative and visible street safety measures. A senior traffic official said these child-friendly designs have been in the making for a while now, and is aimed at creating awareness among children and motorists. This image depicts these new bollards outside St. Bede’s School in Santhome High Road. PHOTO: VELANKANNI RAJ B

THE NEST

PLAY SCHOOL & AFTER-SCHOOL CARE

Nurturing Today, Brightening Tomorrow!

NEW BATCH ADMISSIONS OPEN!

WHERE LITTLE HEARTS GROW & BIG DREAMS BEGIN!

20 MONTHS TO 3 YEARS
SAFE • LOVING • FUN EVERY DAY!

LEARN PLAY GROW TOGETHER!

AFTER-SCHOOL CARE
12:00 PM – 6:30 PM

FUN-FILLED ACTIVITIES

- STORY TIME
- DRAWING & CRAFT
- PHONICS & ABACUS
- YOGA & MINDFULNESS
- SLOKAS & BHAJANS
- HANDWRITING

No. 3, 2nd Main Road, CIT Colony, Mylapore, Chennai-600004

9444038041 • 9176076766 • 9176092272

ENROLL TODAY!
SPACES LIMITED!

A teacher's legacy: from classrooms to canopies

Today, as she retires from service, biology teacher V. Kalaiselvi counts among her achievements a sense of stewardship towards nature particularly trees she instilled in her students. Here is a living testament to this attitude: robust trees at a neighbourhood in Maduravoyal that she helped plant 15 years ago directing a group of NSS volunteers from The Hindu Theological Higher Secondary School in Sowcarpet

School for 18 years, and in the last two years, at WPA Soundarapandian Higher Secondary School in Ayanavaram on compulsory deployment). As she bows out of service, one believes, the saplings she helped plant, and which are now strapping big trees, at Chokkanathan Nagar in Maduravoyal will sway in appreciation.

What was an effort lasting days by NSS student volunteers from this school in Sowcarpet has translated into a gain that continues across years for residents, making summers more bearable and the locality more environmentally sustainable. D. Narasimhan, secretary of the RWA at Chokkanathan Nagar, points out that a majority of trees from that initiative are Indian beech tree (*Pongamia pinnata*).

"The main aim was to increase the oxygen supply and educate the future generation about the importance of nature and the need to protect it," says Kalaiselvi, thrilled at the opportunity to recall and reconstruct the exercise from the ground up.

Funding and logistics demanded meticulous planning, notes Kalaiselvi, adding hands stretched out with generosity, and some of those belonged to the residents. A good amount went out from Kalaiselvi's purse.

From the word go, the exercise had one component going for it: collective community effort. Residents of the locality reportedly welcomed the students wholeheartedly and contributed to the initiative in various ways which included arranging food and ensuring an interactive and pleasant experience for the students. The collective contribution transformed the planting initiative into a source of inspiration. Kalaiselvi also acknowledges the contribution of then deputy mayor P. Benjamin, whose support helped the campaign handsomely.

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

V. Selvaraj, a resident of Chokkanathan Nagar in Maduravoyal and vice president of the enclave's residents welfare association, has a plea for Greater Chennai Corporation: "trim the trees, please!". There is a sense of urgency in that polite but firm imperative and also an unstated pride. He has seen those trees in their "toddler" years, as defenceless saplings. Those days are only 15 years into the past, when a tree-planting campaign swept across Chokkanathan Nagar. It was powered by around 30 NSS students from The Hindu Theological Higher Secondary School in Sowcarpet under the guidance of the school's NSS officer V. Kalaiselvi and the headmastership of V. Selvaraj.

Planted by tender hands, the initiative has photosynthesised into a powerful statement about community service. And the reason to revisit this initiative now? May 31 marks Kalaiselvi's day of retirement. (She served as biology teacher at The Hindu Theological Higher Secondary



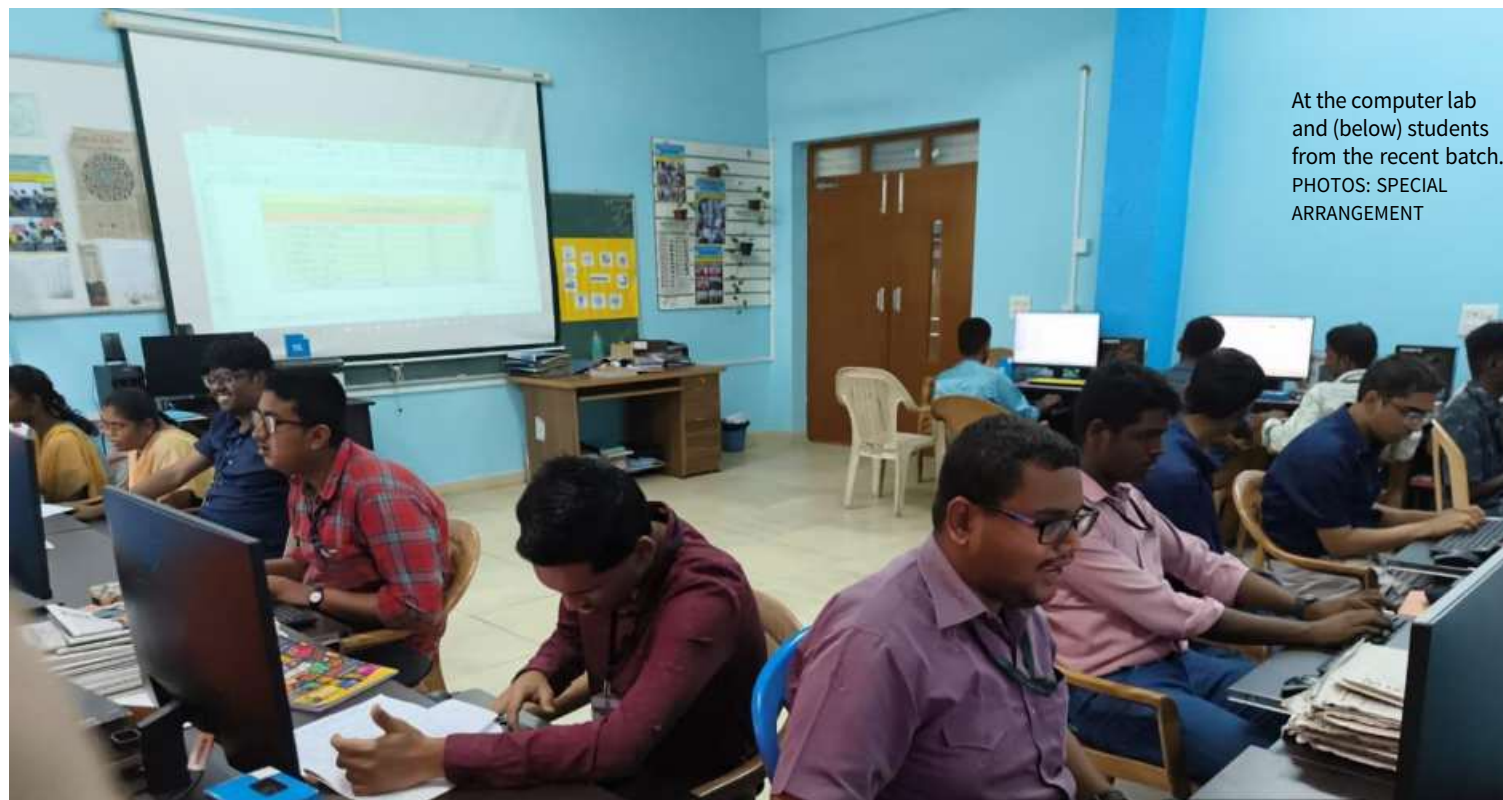
The main aim was to increase the oxygen supply and educate the future generation about the importance of nature and the need to protect it

V. KALAISELVI.

Kalaiselvi has been involved in several social service initiatives over the years, and she clubs this one among those marked by long-term social responsibility. Service of this kind does not bring immediate recognition, as the full extent of its impact is known only years later, and its benefits usually enjoyed only by following generations. "Duty is more important than recognition," says Kalaiselvi, underlining her philosophy of meaningful service.

The once small saplings now provide shade, contribute to cleaner air, and continue to be proof of what sustained community efforts can achieve.

However, as the trees have grown larger over the years, a few branches have extended towards the power lines, raising a safety concern among residents. Hence the plea from Selvaraj to Greater Chennai Corporation to have the trees trimmed. Tree trimming is not just for people's safety, but for the trees' health as well: timely and scientific trimming can keep the trees from getting top-heavy. Therein lies an important lesson; planting trees is only the beginning of environmental stewardship. Preservation demands continual care, and the civic body's support in this area with its tree-trimming equipment cannot be replaced.



At the computer lab and (below) students from the recent batch.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Quick facts

Course: Diploma in Office Automation and Assistive Technology for PwD affiliated with Bharathidasan University

Minimum qualification: SSLC certificate

Who can join: Individuals with Intellectual Disabilities, Autism Spectrum Disorder, Mental Illness, Specific Learning Disabilities, and Multiple Disabilities

Content: Digital literacy, office automation, and exposure to assistive technologies.

Contact: 7667663877 / 7708018648 / 93829 34157

LIFY THOMAS

They are diploma holders and it is a diploma like no other. It imparts training in office automation and assistive technology, but also seeks to put the students in command of their lives. The fifteen students who completed the one-year programme successfully also learnt how to socialise with peers, be independent, besides other social skills.

Diploma in Office Automation and Assistive Technology, as it is called, is offered by National Institute for Empowerment of Persons with Multiple Disabilities (NIEPMD) in Muttukadu. Affiliated with Bharathidasan University in Tiruchirappalli, the two-semester diploma programme is all set to have its fourth batch.

It is designed for those wired differently, blessed with different abilities. Among the 15 graduates, some have intellectual disabilities, some have multiple disabilities and a few are on the autism spectrum. Their abilities outshine their disabilities. At the farewell function held recently on the NIEPMD campus, no one was in any doubt about that. It was a moment to cherish for their parents and teachers.

There is a massive sense of achievement for parents of Suraag Sanjay K, and it comes from the fact that during the course of this diploma programme, he got used to travelling independently. For the first month, from his home in Ambattur to Muttukadu, Suraag, who has intellectual disability, and his father K.G. Sanjay would travel together. His father would drop him and wait at the campus till he finished classes in the evening. A gentle nudge from the faculty got the father-duo to effect a change in that routine. Today, Suraag travels on his own both ways; only on the

Equipped for office, empowered for life

The one-year diploma programme offered by NIEPMD in association with Bharathidasan University strikes a commendable balance between technical and soft skills



home stretch, the last mile, the father picks up the son.

Suraag's classmate Darshan, who has intellectual disability, started travelling by bus while pursuing Class XII. His father L. Gopi raised the bar during in the last one year making him travel by different bus routes. "For instance, during the Chennai Book Fair I dropped him one way and showed him the stop from where he could take his return journey. Another big change I saw in him is the ability to handle situations and also knowing what

to speak when," says Gopi, who works at a private firm.

Skills pertaining to financial literacy, communication and interpersonal dynamics got strengthened through structured group activities, helping the students engage more effectively with peers and instructors. The curriculum also reinforced punctuality, discipline and teamwork, say parents of the students. Besides a host of outdoor activities on the sprawling campus, a faculty from Tamil Nadu Dr. J. Jayalalitha Music and Fine Arts Un-

iversity visits the campus to offer music classes.

The computer lab for DOATT programme was set up with the sponsorship of Geetha Bhavan Trust which also developed a recreation lab for the students.

K. Balabaskar, Lecturer - Department of Adult Independent Learning, NIEPMD, says this inclusive, credit-based higher education programme is one of its kind in India.

"This is a college exclusive for those with special needs where we train them for a year in both techni-

cal know-how and essential life skills to equip them in all respects to take up higher studies or join the workplace," says Balabaskar.

Parents of children with disabilities spend a lot on therapy. "At NIEPMD, it is available within the campus along with a host of other facilities like psychomotor activity that they can avail," says Balabaskar, adding that B. Nithya Prabha, Lecturer and R. Rajesh Kanna, Clinical Assistant are also part of the team.

The one-month internship was another way to sensitise students to the demands of the workplace. Institutions such as Ragas Dental College, TamilNadu JJ. Fisheries University, Karna Vidya Foundation, Anna Centenary Library, MEPZ - Tambaram, Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited in Avadi and even a neighbourhood stationery shop were on board offering internships to students with disabilities.

M. Prabavathy, associate professor, Centre for Differently Abled Persons, Bharathidasan University, says the University has been offering a number of courses for those with special needs since 2011 and NIEPMD requested them to extend this effort to benefit a large section of students.

Under this MoU, Bharathidasan University designs the course, conducts exams and rewards certificates. NIEPMD is the implementing partner. (Bachelor of computer application for speech and hearing impaired, photo editing and 2D animation course for autism are among courses the University offers).

Prabavathy says these are courses where the outcome is more important than considerations such as how many students are enrolled. "Special students need individualised attention as the learning needs are unique for each of them. These courses are aimed at making them independent, both financially and personally," says Prabavathy.

Course coordinators say that some have gone in for higher studies in regular colleges, some have joined the Job Coaching Scheme for TNPSC examination and many have joined the workplace.

Tiny arms stretch out for alms at swanky KNK Road

At the pedestrianised Khader Nawaz Khan Road in Nungambakkam, begging is rampant, and alms-seeking bowls are being carried not just by adults but children. How can you ensure government agencies put these children on the path to education and a better future?

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Price tags inaccessible for a majority, Khader Nawaz Khan Road seemed designed solely for feet encased in a Miu Miu, a Polo Ralph Lauren and the like. That sentence is obviously hyperbole designed for effect. The point to be taken is the road is not just about high-street shopping experiences anymore. After pedestrianisation was walked into the picture, the price tags continued to smile only on select wallets, but the road began to sport a welcoming ear-to-ear grin for everyone.

KNK Road has become a hangout for everyone, not just the haves with a capital H. Aesthetically designed wide walkways doused in decorative lighting impart to the space an Instagrammable appeal: and that automatically opens the floodgates of Gen Zs still in college who subsist on a measly pocket money and Insta-clicks.

Budget-friendly slip-on chappals are at ease striding down KNK Road. And feet with visibly worn-out footwear and with no footwear also traipse in; but these feet often go disturbingly with hands that are stretched out for alms. The contrast between opulence and dire need can be missed anywhere else in Chennai, but not at KNK Road.

Through the day, mendicants can be seen moving along this road, approaching those who can offer them RBI-blessed paper (Indian currency, that is). When someone capable of parting with a 'hallowed paper' or two is spotted, they are relentlessly followed, the beseeching tone kept persistent.



Looking for alms at KNK Road. Though this picture shows an adult, children also beg at the Pedestrian Plaza.
PHOTO: LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

On a few occasions, this reporter has noticed these mendicants declining food and insisting on cash.

John Mathew, a regular at the KNK Road Pedestrian Plaza, observes: "Most of the mendicants refuse food despite incessant offers, instead insist on cash". Even GPay is good enough, Mathew adds with a chuckle, having GPaid a small sum once for a mendicant here. Another visitor notes that they throw away any food given to them, suggesting the preference for cash over food is a well-entrenched attitude among these mendicants.

Speaking from her experience, Joanne .N says they shadow their "target", refusing to take no for an answer; they are dogged in the pursuit of people they assume would part with some cash, following them for long distances. "It can get intimidating," adds Joanne.

Children with begging bowls

Mendicants have as much right to the pedestrianised space at KNK Road as anybody else. But what is disturbing is the shoe size of some of those feet. Small children frequently accompany the adults seeking alms and seek alms alongside those adults. Under the scorching sun, they walk on crowded pavements, extending their tiny hands toward strangers, seeking money. Their presence transforms what might initially be dismissed as a public inconvenience into a serious social concern that requires thought and intervention.

The issue of begging is neither new nor simple. It has existed forever, fostered by migration, poverty, lack of opportunities and systemic socio-economic fault lines. There is also a psychological side to begging: deadbeats, people who have given up the fight, stopped trying to work for their sustenance. However, what is common should not be equated with what is normal. Repeated occurrences should not normalise a problem, making society immune to it. There are systems in place to address this particular problem, systems that could be ineffectual and flabby for want of regular exercise. Rather than extending some succour to the outstretched arms, those systems should be challenged to offer the lasting solutions they promise. Effort should be taken to find out what could be keeping these children on the streets seeking alms. Children belong in schools, not on streets, earning their daily bread with a begging bowl.

Help should be sought. That begs the question: where?

Call child helpline 1098.

Call Chennai District Child Protection Unit – North at 6369124017; Chennai District Child Protection Unit – South is located in Alandur; and Chennai District Child Protection Unit – Central in T. Nagar. There is also support for begging adults, offered by a network of NGOs and government agencies.

Rare insights and photos of Kanchi Mahaswami

Chennai-based non-profit launches a book dedicated to Kanchi Mahaswami's spiritual walk

Sri Siva Vishnu Charitable Trust recently launched a new book titled "En Nenju Niraya Pugunthaar: Sri Kanchi Mahaperiyavaalum Ekambaramaagiya Naanum (Part 2)" at an event held at Sri Thyaga Bhrama Gana Sabha, T. Nagar.

Authored by Ekambaram, a close confidant who dedicated his life to the service (kainkaryam) of the Sage of Kanchi, the book offers an intimate, first hand account of one of the most spiritually significant journeys of the 20th century, said a release.

The book focuses on the padayatra (spiritual walking pilgrimage) undertaken by Sri Kanchi Mahaswami Sri Chandrasekarendra Saraswathi Swamigal- the revered 68th pontiff of the Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetam.



Between 1978 and 1984, Mahaswami traversed 3,860 kilometres over six years, walking from Kanchipuram to Satara. As a constant companion on this gruelling journey, Sri. Ekambaram meticulously chronicles unseen moments, moving accounts of the Mahaswami camping in remote villages and towns, blessing thousands of seekers along the way, and a curated

collection of rare, historical photographs taken during the padayatra, added the release.

The copies of the book were presented to Mani Dravid Shastri, Mahamahopadhyaya and Professor, Chennai Sanskrit College; K. Jayaramakrishnan, industry expert, K. Chandrasekaran, advocate, Chennai High Court, Thiruvallur; N.



During the launch.
PHOTO.
RAGU R

Jayanthi celebration of 'Sage of Kanchi'

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan under the auspices of Neela Subramanian Endowment and in association with Veda Pata Nidhi Trust will celebrate the 132nd Jayanthi of Chandrasekarendra Saraswathi Swamigal (Sage of Kanchi) on May 31 at 6 p.m. at East Mada Street, Mylapore. The programme includes pooja, Veda Parayanam followed by a discourse on "Mahaperiyavalum Guruguhanum" by R.Vijayalakshmi and prasadam distribution. The event is open to all.

TANKER Foundation founder trustee meets Dalai Lama



Amid many cases of kidney disease and kidney failure among underprivileged communities in McLeod Gunj and surrounding regions, Georgi Abraham, Founder Trustee of TANKER Foundation, met Tibetan spiritual leader and Nobel Peace Laureate Dalai Lama on May 23, 2026.

According to a press release, the conversation focused on the work carried out by TANKER foundation in providing free dialysis treatment, conducting awareness programmes and screening camps for early detection and prevention, and supporting research related to renal health.

During the interaction, Dr Abraham said that TANKER foundation would extend support in establishing a dialysis centre in the region which aims to provide free and subsidised dialysis treatment for patients.

WOW Cricket League ends on a high



RVS College of Arts and Science served as the title sponsor of WOW Cricket League (WCL) Season 2.

The tournament, organised by WOW HR at the Jeppiaar Engineering College ground, drew enthusiastic participation from the corporate community.

K. Senthil Ganesh, managing trustee of RVS Educational Institutions, inaugurated the tournament.

The tournament featured nine cor-

porate teams competing in 12 exciting matches, culminating in the crowning of a champion team.

According to a press release, the tournament served as a vibrant platform for networking, team building, and development of meaningful business relationships. WCL is designed to promote employee engagement and corporate networking through the unifying spirit of sports, added the release.

TN Nature Food Producers Federation meets Governor



Senthilkumar Maruthamuthu, state coordinator of the Tamil Nadu Nature Food Producers Federation and Chairman of Cholanadu Farmers Producers Company Ltd, called on Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar at Raj Bhavan recently.

Senthilkumar presented a brief on the agro-ecological transformations led by the Federation, with a special focus on the Cauvery Delta. He highlighted how modern IT enterprise workflows are being synchronised with ancient Tamil wisdom to drive rural prosperity, scale native seed conservation and protect regional biodiversity, said a release.

Environment Day event at lake

As part of World Environment Day celebrations, Saving Nanmangalam Lake Team (SNLT) in co-ordination with NGO Thuvakkam is organising drawing, colouring, and painting activities on June 6.

The activities will be held on a 3,000-square-foot wall opposite the Nanmangalam lake from 3 p.m. to 6.30 p.m.

For details, contact R. Sathya, core volunteer at SNLT, at 90038 35423.



OLIVE SPEECH CENTRE
Providing Speech Therapy for Children & Adults by Qualified Speech Language Pathologist
Location: Old no.334, new no.102, Avvai shanmuga salai, Royapettah, Chennai 600014
Contact: 9952958141

SOFA SERVICE
ANY SOFA'S RECLINER SOFAS CUSHIONS REUPHOLSTERY
Reconditioning @ Very Moderate Charges
K.N.S.RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN

Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787

The death of this Green sea turtle near Akkarai beach a few days ago should serve as a reminder of what we can do to make the Chennai coast truly home for the sea turtles, particularly the Olive Ridley turtles

PRINCE FREDERICK

Here are the details of a recent event by the southern coast of Chennai. A few days ago, Captain A. Ranganathan, a compelling voice in aviation circles and a resident of Injambakkam on the sea-side, chanced by a Green sea turtle that was dead to everything around it. The sad sighting happened on the sands between Akkarai beach and Injambakkam beach. Every event has a lesson: some lessons might not be actionable. What is the lesson, actionable or otherwise, to take away from this?

As a hatchling, this green sea turtle would have dodged a cartel of pelagic predators. As an adult, it would have survived attacks by apex marine predators. All of that for what? Only to be done in by a ridiculous piece of nylon. That is irony of an order where pathos and farcicality exist side by side.

Net loss



A dead Green sea turtle near Akkarai beach.
PHOTO: CAPTAIN A. RANGANATHAN

An inference: danger is often most potent where it is least suspected. A seemingly innocuous civic infra work on the road outside your gates does not get your antennas up;

and you get impaled on steel rods jutting out of an open trench. A fishing net does not get your flippers twitch with anxiety; and you get entangled and find a tragic end. While

that inference could be right, it puts an undue burden on the victim, letting the perpetrator off the hook. Where danger is not expected but hidden and real, those alive to the possibility should take preventive action.

This topic is hardly new: what can be done in the coastal waters to protect sea turtles?

Arun V., coordinator of Students Sea Turtle Conservation Network notes that from the government side, considerable efforts have been taken, largely by way of patrolling to check illegal fishing methods that can result in death of sea turtles.

Despite that, the deaths continue. "Sea turtle deaths in the last two years (actually last two seasons) have been alarming. In relative terms, the deaths have been low in 2026, but that does mean much when you compare it against the huge numbers in 2025."

When Arun is talking about the season, he is essentially talking about the Olive Ridley nesting along the Chennai coast, the nesting happening from January to March, and the hatchlings leaving for the seas in April.

"We do not get Green sea turtles often but Olive Ridley turtles getting entangled in fishing nets is way too common," says Arun. "Those the maximum traffic is around the season, those three to four months of the year, turtle movement is found throughout the year."

Arun notes that one measure, which ought to be definitely taken during the Olive Ridley turtle hatchling season is to avoid laying out the

fishing nets in the waters at night, as it is only at night these turtles come ashore to lay eggs. The possibility of entanglement in nets laid in the coastal waters is high at night during the nesting season. During a recent interaction with fishermen from Nainar Kuppam, this reporter was presented with many cases of how fishermen disentangled sea turtles from fishing nets and eased them back into the waters, safely. Fishing communities along the coast revere sea turtles attaching metaphysical significance to them.

"There is never wanton killing; it is always accidental," says Arun.

The SSTCN coordinator observes that sustainable fishing practices would be a blanket solution, but set against the question of livelihoods for fishing communities, they cannot be activated at will. The best bet would be educate fishing communities how to take certain steps, those factoring in the seasons to prevent turtle deaths from entanglement in nets and injuries from boats. Meanwhile, there are a few things residents of neighbourhoods along the Chennai coast could do for their part to help the cause. Arun lists them out: "Steer clear of misinformation: the biggest challenge this year came from wrong information put out on social media. As a result, many people were disturbing the nesting Olive Ridley turtles with bright lights right on their faces. Turtles abandoned nesting. What residents can do: avoid lights, littering and vehicles on beaches. Corporation should switch off mast lights during the hatchling season."

Making the right moves at

Meet coach and counsellor Ebenezer Joseph who recently won three gold medals in the 60+ category at the Commonwealth Chess Championships

K. KEERTHIVASAN

At 60, Ebenezer Joseph is a bundle of energy. He coaches children, trains teachers, competes in tournaments and also serves as counsellor for educational institutions, strongly advocating the inclusion of chess in school curricula.

Recently, the Anna Nagar resident, who works as an Audit Supervisor in the Indian Audit & Ac-

counts Department (IA & AD) at the Finance and Audit Office in Egmore, made headlines after winning three gold medals in the classical, rapid and blitz events in the 60+ category at the Commonwealth Chess Championships held in Kalutara, Sri Lanka.

Ebenezer was thrilled with the achievement, especially since he had only hoped to return with at least a bronze medal. "I expected to win one bronze medal, but to win three gold medals was unbelievable. Though I won in the 60+ category, I played in the Open sec-



Ebenezer Joseph (second from left) felicitated by Aadhav Arjuna, MLA, Villivakkam and other dignitaries

tion alongside top young Grandmasters such as P. Iniyar and S. Rohith Krishna, besides FIDE Master Sakline Mostafa Sajid, Candidate Master S. Sivathanujan and Woman Candidate Master Ananya Raman. It felt great," he said.

Speaking about the demands of competing in three formats, which often meant spending long hours at the board, Ebenezer said the tournament was physically and mentally exhausting. "The pressure was immense because on certain days we had to play as many as eight rounds.

My matches started at 4 p.m. and finished at 8 p.m., so much so that on the last day I hardly knew what was happening on the board!" he said with a smile.

Having spent more than 34 years with the Indian Audit & Accounts Department, Ebenezer felt the process of obtaining a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from employers to participate in international tournaments should be simplified. "When a player is representing the country, the process of getting an NOC from the employer to take part in an inter-

national event should be made easier," he said.

Ebenezer continues to balance his professional commitments with his passion for chess and social service. "I will continue playing, continue trying to help more sportspeople get recruited into Government offices and continue working with tribal communities," said the 60-year-old, who is also a Senior Lead Instructor for FIDE Chess in Education Commission and is set to retire from IA & AD in November this year.

60